

Durably Sustainability Scan

Detailed methodology - EmpCo and EU Forced Labour Regulation based claim-risk assessment

This methodology explains how the Durably Sustainability Scan reviews company websites or uploaded internal documents for potential greenwashing and social-washing risk signals. The tool is designed as a pre-publication screening and claim-governance support instrument. It is not a legal opinion, not a certification, not formal assurance and not a definitive finding that a company has breached the law.

1. Purpose and scope

The scan focuses on sustainability claims, not on overall ESG performance. It checks whether the wording used by a company is sufficiently specific, substantiated, balanced and consistent with relevant public-source context. The output is intended for sustainability, legal, compliance, communications and marketing teams before external publication or campaign launch.

Input type	How it is treated
Website scan	Reviews the submitted URL and, where possible, a limited set of related company pages. The result can include external public-source signals where search credentials are configured.
Internal document scan	Reviews only the uploaded document. It does not combine the file with a website scan. External-source signals are not treated as part of the uploaded document unless explicitly configured in a separate workflow.
Output	Three separate scores: Global score, Green score and Social score. The report also contains detected wording, source location, red flags, external public-source signals and recommended actions.

2. Regulatory and standards lenses

The methodology gives highest weight to explicit regulatory risk lenses directly relevant to sustainability claims. Broader ESG standards are used as supporting lenses for evidence quality, governance and due diligence.

Lens	How it is used in the scan
EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825	Used for consumer-facing green claims. The scan looks for generic environmental claims, absolute claims, carbon-neutrality or offsetting claims, labels/icons, future environmental-performance claims, comparative claims, and claims presenting legal requirements as a distinctive benefit.
Green Claims Directive proposal / EU guidance	Used as a best-practice substantiation lens where relevant: claims should be science-based, specific, transparent, high-quality-data backed, and communicated with sufficient information for the average consumer.
EU Forced Labour Regulation / Regulation (EU) 2024/3015	Used for social claims involving products, suppliers, imports/exports, traceability, modern slavery or forced-labour-free wording. The scan checks whether claims imply assurance without product/supplier traceability, risk assessment, mitigation, remediation and response readiness.
CSRD / ESRS	Used to assess whether social and environmental statements are backed by policies, actions, targets, metrics, stakeholder groups, reporting boundaries and limitations.
OECD Guidelines, UNGPs, ILO, UNGC, GRI	Used as supporting lenses for human-rights due diligence, labour rights, affected stakeholders, grievance/remedy, supplier responsibility and balanced sustainability reporting.

3. Claim detection methodology

The scan identifies potentially sensitive sustainability wording. A detected word is not automatically a problem: the risk depends on the full sentence, the medium, the audience, the scope, the evidence and whether the wording could mislead the average reader. The company report highlights problematic trigger terms in context and shows the source page, link or uploaded document where the wording was found.

Claim module	Examples of triggers	Core review question
Generic green claims	green, eco, natural, sustainable, environmentally friendly, climate-friendly	Is the claim clearly specified on the same medium and linked to recognised excellent environmental performance or objective evidence?
Carbon / offsetting claims	carbon neutral, climate neutral, CO2 neutral, climate compensated, net zero product	Does the claim imply neutral or reduced product impact, and is it based on real reductions rather than offsetting?
Labels, icons and visual claims	leaf icons, planet icons, green badges, eco labels, self-declared marks	Could a symbol, badge, image, alt text, class name or label imply a certified or broader environmental benefit than the evidence supports?
Future claims	we will be net zero, climate positive by, sustainable by 2030	Is there a clear, objective, publicly available, verifiable plan with measurable milestones and monitoring?
Comparative claims	better for the planet, greener than, more sustainable than, lowest footprint	Is the comparison method, comparator, data source, scope and update mechanism clear?
Social / supply-chain claims	ethical sourcing, responsible suppliers, forced-labour free, traceable, child-labour free	Does the claim overstate supplier control, audit coverage, worker voice, grievance/remedy, traceability or due-diligence evidence?

4. Evidence-gap assessment

The scan looks for evidence indicators in the reviewed material, such as scope, reporting period, baseline, KPI, methodology, limitations, assurance, verification, audit coverage, supplier tiers, grievance mechanisms, remediation, traceability and corrective actions. A broad claim with little supporting evidence receives a higher substantiation-risk component.

Evidence element	Low risk when present	Higher risk when missing
Scope and boundary	Clear product, activity, geography, supplier tier, reporting period or channel scope.	Claim may be interpreted as applying to the whole company, all products, all suppliers or all impacts.
Methodology and data	Named method, data source, baseline, KPI and calculation approach.	Claim appears subjective, vague or unverifiable.
Verification or assurance	Independent certification, recognised label, assurance, audit or public-authority scheme where relevant.	Self-declared label, badge or assurance-like wording may mislead.
Limitations and caveats	Limitations are prominent and linked to the claim on the same page/medium.	Main claim is prominent but qualification is hidden, absent or too remote.
Due diligence and remedy	Human-rights or supplier claims show risk assessment, grievance channels, corrective actions and remediation.	Social claims may imply control or positive outcomes without evidence.

5. Score calculation method

The Sustainability Scan produces three scores on a 0-100 risk scale. A higher score means higher claim-risk exposure and stronger need for manual review, substantiation or reformulation. Scores are indicative screening signals and are intentionally conservative when direct EmpCo or Forced Labour Regulation indicators appear.

Score	Calculation logic	
Green score	Combines green claim-wording risk, green substantiation/evidence-gap risk, external green-claim context, visual/icon signals and audience sensitivity. EmpCo-relevant blacklisted-practice indicators can cap or raise the score even without a controversy source.	
Social score	Combines social claim-wording risk, substantiation/evidence-gap risk, external contradictory context and sector sensitivity. Forced-labour, modern-slavery, supplier, import/export or traceability claims receive additional weighting under Regulation (EU) 2024/3015.	
Global score	Conservative combined result of the Green and Social scores. It should not hide a high green or high social red flag; the report therefore displays all three scores separately in the executive summary.	
Component	Role	Description
Claim wording risk	High weighting	How broad, generic, absolute, future-oriented, comparative, visual, label-based, supplier-related or assurance-like the claim is.
Substantiation / evidence-gap risk	High weighting	Whether the reviewed page or document contains objective evidence, scope, methodology, KPIs, limitations, verification or due-diligence evidence.
External public-source context	Modifier / contradiction layer	Public-source signals that may contradict or qualify company claims. Company-owned websites, policies and reports are excluded from this external-signal layer.
Sector and channel sensitivity	Baseline modifier	High-exposure sectors, consumer-facing channels, product claims and supply-chain claims receive stricter review. Sector sensitivity alone should not create a high-risk finding.
Regulatory red-flag override	Cap / uplift mechanism	Clear EmpCo or Forced Labour Regulation indicators can raise the score or prevent a low result, because one problematic claim can create material legal or reputational exposure.

Indicative interpretation bands

Risk band	Meaning
0-29 Low	No clear high-risk claim signal detected, or claim appears sufficiently specific and evidenced in the reviewed material.
30-49 Moderate	Potentially broad or insufficiently evidenced claim; manual review recommended before publication.
50-74 Elevated	Sensitive claim wording, evidence gap or external/context signal; reformulation and evidence file recommended.
75-100 High / very high	Direct regulatory red flag, strong overstatement, major evidence gap and/or relevant contradictory public-source signals; legal/compliance review should be prioritised.

6. External public-source signals

External public-source signals are not used as final proof. They are review signals that help identify whether public allegations, enforcement activity, litigation, NGO reports, regulator findings or credible press coverage may contradict or qualify the company claim. For example, a broad responsible-sourcing claim is more sensitive when external sources mention supplier labour allegations or forced-labour concerns.

The tool separates company-owned evidence from external signals. Company sustainability reports, supplier codes and policy pages may support a claim, but they are not treated as independent external public-source signals.

Source treatment	Included as external signal?
Regulators, courts, authorities, EU/OECD/ILO/UN materials	Yes, if relevant to the company or claim theme.
Credible press, NGOs, civil-society reports, complaints, litigation or enforcement notices	Yes, if relevant and not company-owned.
Company sustainability reports, annual reports, policies, supplier codes, own websites	No, not in the external-signal layer. They may be used as company evidence.
Unrelated search results, promotional content, awards, generic sector news	Filtered out where possible. Manual review remains necessary.

7. Visual and icon review

Because environmental claims can be made through text, labels, images, symbols, colours, badges, product names or trade names, the scan also checks HTML cues such as alt text, title attributes, class names, IDs and image filenames for potential visual sustainability signals. Examples include leaf, eco, green, planet, recycled, carbon, climate, badge, label, certificate and similar cues. This does not replace manual image review, but it helps flag visual material that may imply a benefit.

8. How to use the results

- Treat the three scores separately: a low global score should not hide a high green or social red flag.
- Review the detected wording in context, especially highlighted trigger terms and source page/document.
- Attach an evidence file to every claim: scope, method, KPI, date, source, owner, limits and approval record.
- For consumer-facing green claims, check same-medium specification and EmpCo blacklisted-practice risk before publication.
- For product, supplier, traceability or forced-labour claims, check Regulation (EU) 2024/3015 readiness: risk assessment, traceability, mitigation, remediation and response procedure.
- Use the 2-page company report as a management summary, and the claim register CSV as an operational working file.

9. Limitations

The scan depends on what the website or document exposes to automated review. It cannot fully interpret images, videos, PDFs with poor text extraction, private evidence files, legal context or internal substantiation unless provided. Automated search results can be incomplete, stale or noisy. All findings require manual validation by legal, compliance and subject-matter experts before external use.

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